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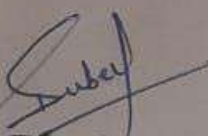
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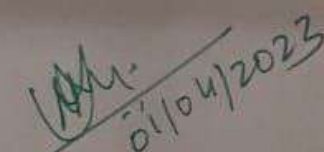
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- 1- Mohan Krishna and Meera Banerji, Developing Communication Skills, Macmillan Press
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UNIT-2 (COMMUNICATION SKILLS)-B.TECH -2 SEM**MODULE II: LISTENING AND READING****LECTURE NO:-8****EFFECTIVE LISTENING AND ITS IMPORTANCE**

Listening is a significant part of communication process. Communication cannot take place until and unless a message is heard and retained thoroughly and positively by the receivers/listeners. Listening is a dynamic process. Listening means attentiveness towards the posture as well as expressions. Listening implies decoding (i.e., translating the symbols into meaning) and interpreting the messages correctly in communication process.

Listening differs from hearing in sense that:

Hearing implies just perceiving the sounds while listening means listening with understanding whatever you are listening. Both the body as well as mind is involved in listening process.

Listening is an active process while hearing is a passive activity.

Hearing is an effortless activity while listening is an act requiring conscious efforts, concentration and interest. Listening involves both physical and psychological efforts.

Effective listening requires both deliberate efforts and a keen mind. Effective listeners appreciate flow of new ideas and information. Organizations that follow the principles of effective listening are always informed timely, updated with the changes and implementations, and are always out of crisis situation.

To improve your communication skills, you must learn to listen effectively. Effective listening gives you an advantage and makes you more impressive when you speak. It also boosts your performance.

EFFECTIVE LISTENING SKILLS

- ✚ Discover your interests' field.
- ✚ Grasp and understand the matter/content.
- ✚ Remain calm. Do not lose your temper. Anger hampers and inhibits communication. Angry people jam their minds to the words of others.
- ✚ Be open to accept new ideas and information.
- ✚ Jot down and take a note of important points.
- ✚ Work upon listening. Analyze and evaluate the speech in spare time.
- ✚ Rephrase and summarize the speaker's ideas.
- ✚ Keep on asking questions. This demonstrates that how well you understand the speaker's ideas and also that you are listening.
- ✚ Avoid distractions.
- ✚ "Step into the shoes of others", i.e., put yourself in the position of the speaker and observe things from his view point. This will help creating an atmosphere of mutual understanding and improve the exchange of ideas in communication process.

IMPORTANCE OF LISTENING SKILLS IN COMMUNICATION

Listening skills are a vital part of good communication. If you have good communication skills, you can start to improve relationships in the workplace as well as in society. Also, you will be able to make decisions more effectively and reach a quicker agreement with others. Here are 7 reasons why listening skills are essential:

1. Reduces Misunderstandings

Poor communication always results in misunderstandings. And, poor communication arises from poor listening skills. People end up assuming things and misunderstanding each other if they do not share their side of the stories or listen to others actively. So, it's easy to mishear something or misinterpret information. Such misunderstanding can gradually keep increasing if the listening skills in communication are not improved.

2. Builds Empathy

Empathy is essential to effective listening. Therefore, it would be best if you mirrored the emotions the speaker has. For example, if the speaker's face expresses sadness or joy, your facial expressions and words should also express similar emotions. Empathy towards the speaker takes concentration and consumes energy, allowing open communication and establishing relationships.

3. Limits Judgements

Listening limits judgements. While actively listening to someone, your total concentration stays in the conversation. As a result, you try your best to understand the other person or group of people and remove judgmental thoughts. You, therefore, listen to the speaker with an open mind because they are giving you their perspective. You may realise that the speech makes more sense as they continue the lecture.

4. Improves Business Relationships

If you are working in a customer-centric or interactive role, your communication skills play a big part in your success. Thus, practising good listening skills with everyone at the workplace would benefit your success. You could also build stronger bonds with your co-workers. As a result, everyone will respect you more and value you.

5. Increases Productivity

Whether you're at work or home, listening is essential to your success. Good listeners are more likely to store information and understand what's being required of them. This is a valuable skill in group projects and meetings. People may think they need to talk a lot to contribute, but listening is arguably more essential. If everyone listens to each other, there is less room for misunderstandings. This increases everyone's productivity.

6. Enhances Leadership Skills

Leaders always have good listening skills in communication. Active listening helps you connect with your team's ideas, hear various perspectives, and prevent miscommunications. In addition, a good team leader ensures everyone feels respected, which means they all feel listened to. They always listen to others and help them in every possible way.

7. Providing Feedback

Providing feedback to the speaker can only be achieved through active listening. The goal of feedback is to send signals to the speaker to know that you are actively listening. The medium of feedback can be verbal or non-verbal.

For example, you can use "okay, or I understand it" for verbal feedback. And for non-verbal feedback, you can nod your head and other appropriate facial expressions. Writing down what the speaker is saying also shows your attentiveness.

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- 3- <https://resources.noodle.com/other/other/7-tips-to-overcome-the-reading-struggle/>

UNIT-2 (COMMUNICATION SKILLS)-B.TECH -2 SEM**MODULE II: LISTENING AND READING****LECTURE NO:-9****BARRIERS TO LISTENING**

Listening is not easy and there are a number of obstacles that stand in the way of effective listening, both within outside the workplace.

These barriers may be categorized as follows.

1- Physiological Barriers: -

Some people may have genuine hearing problems or deficiencies that prevent them from listening properly. It can be treated. Some people may have problem in processing information or retaining information in the memory. For example Lack of concentration/interest.

2- Physical Barriers: -

These referred to distraction in the environment such as the sound of an air conditioner , cigarette smoke, or an overheated room. It can interfere the Listening process. They could also be in the form of information overload. For example, if you are in meeting with your manager and the phone rings and your mobile beeps at the same time to let u know that you have the message. It is very hard to listen carefully to what is being said. Arriving late for a speech, presentation or lecture. Therefore unavailability of listeners, Speaker or listener being distracted by disturbances will also be coming into physical barrier category.

3- Attitudinal Barriers: -

Pre occupation with personal or work related problems can make it difficult to focus one's attention completely on what speaker is saying, even what is being said is of very importance. Another common attitudinal barrier is egocentrism, or the belief that the people have more knowledgeable than the speaker, or that there is nothing new to learn from the speaker's ideas. People with this kind of close minded attitude are very poor listeners

4. Wrong Assumptions: - The success of communication depend on the both the sender and receiver. It is wrong to assume that communication is the sole responsibility of the sender or the speaker and that listener have no role to play. Such an assumption can be big barrier to listening. For example, a brilliant speech or presentation, however well delivered, is wasted if the receiver is not listening at the other end. Listeners have as much responsibility as speakers to make the communication successful. The process should be made successful by paying attention seeking clarifications and giving feedback. Another example: Assuming that the speaker is going to give some unimportant information .or Pre-judgments about the speaker

5. Cultural Barriers:- Accents can be barriers to listening, since they interfere with the ability to understand the meaning of words that are pronounced differently. The problem of different accents arises not only between cultures, but also within a culture. For example, in a country like India where there is enormous cultural diversity, accents may differ even between regions states.

6. Gender Barriers:- communication research has shown that gender can be barrier to listening. Studies have revealed that men and women listen very differently and for different purposes. Women are more likely to listen for the emotion behind a speaker's words, when men listen more for the facts and the content.

7. Lack of Training: - Listening is not an inborn skill. People are not born good listeners. It is developed through practice and training. Lack of training in listening skills is an important barrier. In lack of training people do avoid listening to difficult, boring or complex information and selectively listen only to what is considered interesting.

8. Bad Listening Habits: - Most people are very average listeners who have developed poor listening habits that are hard to said and that act as barriers to listening. For example, some people have the habits of “faking” attention, or trying to look like a listeners, in order to impress the speaker and to assure him that they are paying attention. Others may tend to listen to each and every fact and, as a result, miss out the main point. For example Judging the speaker by his/her mannerisms, voice, appearance, accent, etc

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UNIT-2 (COMMUNICATION SKILLS)-B.TECH -2 SEM**MODULE II: LISTENING AND READING****LECTURE NO:-10****GUIDELINES FOR EFFECTIVE LISTENING SKILLS****WAYS TO IMPROVE LISTENING SKILL**

Hearing and Listening are two different activity. Hearing is passive whereas Listening is active. Listening is a psychological process. It can therefore be improved by regular practice. Listening is a very helpful skill. Active listening is really an extension of the Golden Rule. Here are some of the tips which can help the person to improve his Listening skill:

1. Face the speaker. Sit up straight or lean forward slightly to show your attentiveness through body language.

2. Maintain eye contact, to the degree that you all remain comfortable. In a meeting or public speaking, you should always maintain eye contact with the speaker. By doing this, you are giving your undivided attention to the speaker. Also, it shows that you are making an effort to understand what they are saying. As a result, the speaker will feel they are being appreciated for their effort.

Also, it gives them a non-verbal indication that you are interested in what they are saying, which encourages them to continue expressing themselves. So, you should limit any unnecessary distractions in meetings and public speaking. For example, you should avoid:

- Texting or scrolling through your phone,
- Looking out a window,
- Scanning a computer screen

- Body language such as biting your finger, running your finger into your hair, etc.

3. Minimize external distractions. Turn off the TV. Put down your book or magazine, and ask the speaker and other listeners to do the same.

4. Respond appropriately to show that you understand. Murmur (“uh-huh” and “um-hmm”) and nod. Raise your eyebrows. Say words such as “Really,” “Interesting,” as well as more direct prompts: “What did you do then?” and “What did she say?”

5. Focus solely on what the speaker is saying. Try not to think about what you are going to say next. The conversation will follow a logical flow after the speaker makes her point.

6. Minimize internal distractions. If your own thoughts keep horning in, simply let them go and continuously re-focus your attention on the speaker, much as you would during meditation.

7. Keep an open mind. Wait until the speaker is finished before deciding that you disagree. Try not to make assumptions about what the speaker is thinking.

8. Engage yourself. Ask questions for clarification, but, once again, wait until the speaker has finished. That way, you won’t interrupt their train of thought. After you ask questions, paraphrase their point to make sure you didn’t misunderstand. Start with: “So you’re saying...”

09. Do Not Interrupt

Everyone’s capacity to understand a subject is different. For example, in some matters, you may not understand everything that someone says to you. So, you may want to ask a question to back up and clarify the topic or phrase you misunderstood.

However, you should wait for a pause in their speech and then ask your question. This way, you are showing the speaker that you are listening, paying attention and willing to discuss

things further. The speaker will also appreciate it because they can finish the speech without interrupting.

10. Pay Attention to Non-Verbal Cues

Most of the time, our communication medium is non-verbal. Our body language and voice tone often give out what we are feeling even without saying anything. You can detect if the speaker is bored, irritated, or enthusiastic by just looking at their eyes, mouth, and shoulders position.

SO TO SUMMARIES HOW TO LISTEN EFFECTIVELY?

- Stop Talking – Be Silent
- Show Interest
- Empathize
- Ask Questions
- Maintain Eye Contact
- Take notes
- Listen Creatively
- Put Your Entirety
- Send feedback
- Avoid or eliminate distraction
- Try to gather information about the topic to develop interest and familiarity

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1. Mohan Krishna and Meera Banerji, Developing Communication Skills, Macmillan Press
2. <https://www.skillsyouneed.com/ips/communication-skills.html>
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UNIT-2 (COMMUNICATION SKILLS)-B.TECH -2 SEM**MODULE II: LISTENING AND READING****LECTURE NO:-11****THE ART OF READING**

“There is no friend as loyal as a book”, said American author Ernest Hemingway. Books fire up your imagination, provide solace in times of grief, and open up your world.

The importance of a reading habit is intrinsically linked to professional success, as it opens up the mind to new experiences and provides new avenues of knowledge.

Reading can make you a better writer and speaker. Reading skills can take you a step ahead and help you achieve your objectives by customizing the way you read. If you choose the appropriate reading skill, it will enhance the reading process and help you achieve your goal.

THE IMPORTANCE OF READING

Reading enhances our life in several ways:

1- Exercising Your Mind

One of the advantages of reading is that it engages various parts of your brain. When you read, you exercise your comprehension abilities and your analytical abilities. It fires up your imagination and stimulates the memory centers of your mind. It helps recall information as well as stabilize your emotions.

The importance of a reading habit is that it strengthens mental muscles. Reading is one of the best mental workouts there is. It's been found that regular mental stimulation can slow

down and possibly even prevent diseases like Alzheimer's and dementia. Reading keeps the mind agile and young.

2- The Role Of Reading Skills In Communication

Reading and writing work in similar ways. Reading improves your writing style and flow. Writers learn to perfect their craft by taking inspiration from other writers. It's impossible to be a good writer if you don't read.

Another vital role of reading skills in communication is perfecting your oratory skills. Reading teaches you new words and perspectives. It helps strengthen language and sharpens sentence structure. It gives you a better command over the language. All of these are critical to being a good speaker.

3- Finding Yourself

Books work as portals to newer worlds. They have the potential to broaden your perspective, shape your attitude towards others and life, and open you up to new ways of thinking about everyday life.

4- Becoming A Well-Read Individual

The words "well-read" are often used to denote a learned individual, full of wisdom. Before the internet, books were the only sources of information and knowledge. Books contain the collective wisdom of our times. The more you read, the more you will learn about the world and the people in it. One of the great benefits of reading is that it helps you evolve your understanding of the world.

5- Keeping Calm And Entertained

Books can be a perfect escape from reality. They can cheer you up when you're down, motivate you when you're sad, and even keep you company when everybody else is busy.

One of the benefits of reading is that it relaxes your mind and body. You recharge your energy levels much faster when you read. Reading is the best way to end the day on a calm note. It may even help you fall asleep much faster.

6- Helps Master A Language

Reading is one of the best ways to learn a new language or gain mastery over a known one. Also, when you learn through stories, you learn much faster.

Learning about words through context is one of the most organic ways to understand their meaning and improve your vocabulary.

7- Keeps You Grounded

Reading is a constant exercise in humility. The more you read, the more you realize how much you haven't. That reminds you of how much further you still need to go. Each book reminds you of how limited your knowledge is.

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1. Mohan Krishna and Meera Banerji, Developing Communication Skills, Macmillan Press
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UNIT-2 (COMMUNICATION SKILLS)-B.TECH -2 SEM**MODULE II: LISTENING AND READING****LECTURE NO:-12****TYPES OF READING TECHNIQUES****1- SKIMMING**

Skimming sometimes referred to as gist reading, means going through the text to grasp the main idea. Here, the reader doesn't pronounce each and every word of the text but focuses their attention on the main theme or the core of the text. Examples of skimming are reading magazines or newspapers and searching for a name in a telephone directory.

2- SCANNING

Here, the reader quickly scuttles across sentences to get to a particular piece of information. Scanning involves the technique of rejecting or ignoring irrelevant information from the text to locate a specific piece of information.

3- INTENSIVE READING

Intensive reading is far more time-consuming than skimming and scanning as it needs the reader's attention to detail. It involves close reading that aims at the accuracy of comprehension. Here, the reader has to understand the meaning of each and every word.

4- EXTENSIVE READING

Extensive reading lays more emphasis on fluency and less on accuracy. It usually involves reading for pleasure and is more of an out-of-classroom activity. It is highly unlikely for readers to take up the extensive reading of text they do not like.

SOME OF THE BARRIERS TO EFFECTIVE READING ARE AS FOLLOWS-**1- Lack of grammatical and linguistic competence:**

Many people cannot read effectively because they fail to decrypt grammatical and lexical units of language in the text. They lack the ability to differentiate and recognize the words, sentences, expressions, used in the text. It hampers the process of reading. The reader may stop reading further if he fails to understand the text grammatically.

2- Lack of motivation:

Reading for information and knowledge requires motivation and discipline. Many people think reading as boring and time consuming task. Lack of proper motivation and goal may create barrier to reading.

3- Lack of concentration:

If the reader lacks concentration while reading, he just will turn pages after pages without much comprehension.. It requires careful attention of the reader.

4- Proper light and ventilation:

A reader has to struggle a lot to read in dim light or dark rooms. If proper ventilation is not there in the reading room, reader may feel suffocated or tired.

5- Size of the book:

Normally, people prefer reading small size articles and texts. If the book contains volumes of pages, it decreases the interest of the reader.

6- Articulating the words and sentences loudly:

Many readers have habit to articulate loudly or murmur the words in the text. They buzz each word which creates a barrier to speed reading.

7- Putting finger, pen or any object on the words and sentences while reading:

Many people put their finger or pen on the text while reading. They move the finger or object from word to word which lowers down the process of reading.

8- Narrow eye span:

Many readers read the text into independent eye shift between each and every word. They have narrow eye span. It not only decreases the speed of reading but also affects the comprehension. Shorter the eye span, slower the speed and comprehension. Readers require proper training and techniques to expand their eye span.

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